

TEN PROMPTS · COPY, FILL THE BRACKETS, PASTE

10 copy-paste AI prompts for teachers

Every prompt below is safe as written: no student information goes in, and the brackets show exactly what to fill. Copy one, swap the [BRACKETS] for your specifics, and review the draft like the professional you are before anything reaches a student or family.

BEFORE THE FIRST PROMPT, THE RULE

Never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool.
Describe the need, not the child.

Planning

1 · Three lesson hooks

"You are an experienced [GRADE/SUBJECT] teacher. Give me three different 5-minute openings for a lesson on [TOPIC]: one a question, one a quick activity, one a surprising fact. Keep each practical for a real classroom."

2 · Lesson skeleton from messy notes

"Turn these rough notes into a [LENGTH]-minute lesson plan for [GRADE/SUBJECT]: [PASTE NOTES]. Format: a table with timings, materials, and teacher moves, plus a 3-question exit check at the end."

3 · Substitute plan in a pinch

"Write a one-page substitute plan for a [GRADE] class covering [TOPIC]. Include a bell-ringer, a main activity with simple numbered directions, an early-finisher task, and management notes. Assume the sub has never met these students."

Differentiation

4 · Level a reading passage

"Rewrite this passage at a [GRADE] reading level, keeping the key vocabulary I've marked: [PASTE PASSAGE]. Then add three comprehension questions that build from literal to inferential."

5 · One task, three levels

"Take this activity: [PASTE ACTIVITY]. Create three versions for [GRADE]: one with more scaffolding, one on grade level, and one extension. Do not reference any specific student; I'll match versions to kids myself."

Assessment

6 · Student-friendly rubric

"Create a 4-level rubric for this assignment: [DESCRIBE ASSIGNMENT]. Criteria: [LIST 3-4 CRITERIA]. Write the descriptors so a [GRADE] student can self-assess with it."

7 · Exit ticket set

"Based on this objective: [PASTE OBJECTIVE], write three exit-ticket questions: one recall, one application, one reflection. Each answerable in under two minutes. Include an answer key."

8 · Feedback sentence starters

"Give me ten feedback sentence starters for [GRADE] work that are kind, specific, and actionable. Group them by strength and next step. Keep them general so I can apply them to any student's work myself."

Communication

9 · Family newsletter blurb

"You are a warm, organized [GRADE] teacher. Write a newsletter blurb for families about [TOPIC/EVENT]. Context: [KEY DETAILS]. Format: under 150 words, skimmable on a phone, action items as a short bulleted list."

10 · The reusable template (build once, reuse forever)

"You are a [GRADE/SUBJECT] teacher. Create a [NUMBER]-question review on [TOPIC] for students who [WHAT THEY STRUGGLE WITH]. Format: [FORMAT]. Include an answer key."

Getting better results from any of these

- **The colleague test:** if a colleague with zero context would be confused by your prompt, the AI will be too. Add the context a substitute would need.
- **Iterate in rounds:** the first draft is a proposal. Fix content first ("question 4 is too hard"), then voice ("warmer; I'd never say 'furthermore'"), then details ("shorten by a third").
- **Verify anything factual.** AI can be confidently wrong. You are the expert; it is the eager intern.

The permanent rules ride along: no student personally identifiable information in public AI tools, ever. And a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or family.

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